McDonald's CSR Challenge



Case Summary

Brand Marketing report in April 2010 **revealed disconnect** between McDonalds **newest CSR initiatives** and **customer perception.**



What did this disconnect look like...

What did this disconnect look like...

- People never noticed the new logo

NEW

Environmental Commitment



OLD



What did this disconnect look like...

- People never noticed the new logo
- Didn’t view McDonald’s as socially responsible



What went wrong?

- Communication gap
- Skepticism about motives
- Perception gaps from customers and employees
- Scattered projects, no strategic plan



Issues

Issues

ONE-WAY COMMUNICATION

- Informs costumers, doesn't listen
- "Responsibility" defined by their point of view

Issues

ONE-WAY COMMUNICATION

- Informs costumers, doesn't listen
- "Responsibility" defined by their point of view

PASSIVE COSTUMERS

- No way to follow/take part in CSR efforts
- Programs happen behind the scenes

Issues

ONE-WAY COMMUNICATION

- Informs costumers, doesn't listen
- "Responsibility" defined by their point of view

NO CREDIBILITY

- Claims aren't backed by evidence
- Strong partners are barely communicated
- CSR just for image

PASSIVE COSTUMERS

- No way to follow/take part in CSR efforts
- Programs happen behind the scenes

Issues

ONE-WAY COMMUNICATION

- Informs costumers, doesn't listen
- "Responsibility" defined by their point of view

NO CREDIBILITY

- Claims aren't backed by evidence
- Strong partners are barely communicated
- CSR just for image

PASSIVE COSTUMERS

- No way to follow/take part in CSR efforts
- Programs happen behind the scenes

ASSOCIATIONS WITH FAST FOOD

- Health: Super Size Me image
- Environment: packaging waste
- Employees: “McJobs" stereotype

Strategy

Strategy

PRIORITIZE RELEVANT ISSUES

Focus on the issues
people care about

Strategy

PRIORITIZE RELEVANT ISSUES

Focus on the issues people care about

CREATE TWO-WAY COMMUNICATION

Let customers comment, vote on future priorities, and suggest improvements.

Strategy

PRIORITIZE RELEVANT ISSUES

Focus on the issues people care about

CREATE TWO-WAY COMMUNICATION

Let customers comment, vote on future priorities, and suggest improvements.

COMMUNICATE TRANSPARENTLY

Share goals, results and gaps

Strategy

PRIORITIZE RELEVANT ISSUES

Focus on the issues people care about

CREATE TWO-WAY COMMUNICATION

Let customers comment, vote on future priorities, and suggest improvements.

COMMUNICATE TRANSPARENTLY

Share goals, results and gaps

ENCOURAGE PARTICIPATION

Offer loyalty points when customers return eligible packaging

Strategy

PRIORITIZE RELEVANT ISSUES

Focus on the issues people care about

CREATE TWO-WAY COMMUNICATION

Let customers comment, vote on future priorities, and suggest improvements.

COMMUNICATE TRANSPARENTLY

Share goals, results and gaps

ENCOURAGE PARTICIPATION

Offer loyalty points when customers return eligible packaging

MAKE INFORMATION ACCESSIBLE

Add QR codes to packaging that link to a McDonald’s CSR progress website for customers.


Your voice matters
Vote on what we improve next.
Packaging
Sourcing
Nutrition
People
See our progress
Scan for goals, results & what still needs work.
Packaging
Sourcing
Nutrition
People
Return eligible packaging. Earn points.


Our Food
Our Planet
Our People
Our Communities
A better tomorrow
STUDENT CONCEPT · ILLUSTRATIVE DATA
Follow every package further.
From our restaurants to new life, we're working to keep packaging in use and out of landfill. Track our progress, see how it works, and find out what's next.
Return eligible packaging →
See the evidence
1,248,620
packages recycled · sample figure
Give packaging a second life.
Return eligible packaging here.
Recycled packages over time
250K
200K
150K
100K
50K
0
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May
Jun
Progress towards our example goal
62%
of example annual goal
We're on track to recycle more packaging this year, with bigger progress ahead.
How we count
We track eligible packaging returned through in-restaurant collection, weigh and verify it, and record it for this dashboard.
Last updated
30 June 2024
What still needs work
Some packaging, such as certain food wrappers and composite materials, is harder to recycle. We're testing new solutions and working with suppliers to do more.
Small returns make a big difference.
Help us keep packaging in use. Return eligible packaging at participating restaurants.
Good things add up.
Illustrative figures for a class concept — not McDonald's reported results.


Good food brighter tomorrows
9:41
MyMcDonald's Rewards
STUDENT CONCEPT · ILLUSTRATIVE REWARDS
All rewards
Food
Experiences
Packaging returns
Return packaging. Earn points.
120 points
3 eligible returns
Next reward
200 points
80 points to next reward
Find a return point
How it works
1
Check eligible packaging
2
Return at a participating restaurant
3
Scan to collect points
Example reward · 200 points
Regular soft drink
Availability and terms would appear here at launch.
Home
Rewards
Return
Account

QR Hunt · Vienna

THE GREAT QR HUNT IS ON.

6 codes hidden across Vienna.
Find them. Scan them. Win.

SWIPE →
#SCANTHESTORY

How it works

4 STEPS TO PLAY

1. **FIND**
   Follow the clues in our Stories to a QR code hidden in Vienna.
2. **SCAN**
   Open the McDonald's app and tap "Scan the Story".
3. **WIN**
   Your reward appears in the app, ready to use.
4. **MEET A FAMILY**
   Every code unlocks the story of a real family.

SWIPE →
#SCANTHESTORY

The map

6 SPOTS. 6 CODES. 6 FAMILIES.



Every code unlocks the story of a family who stayed at the Ronald McDonald Kinderhilfe house in Vienna, close to their child in hospital.

SWIPE →
#SCANTHESTORY

Rewards

THE MORE YOU FIND, THE MORE YOU WIN.

1 CODE	Free medium fries
3 CODES	Free McFlurry
6 CODES	Free menu + "Golden Hunter" badge in the app
+€1 EVERY SCAN	goes to the Ronald McDonald Kinderhilfe

SWIPE →
#SCANTHESTORY

A family

BEHIND EVERY CODE: A FAMILY.

~1,700

families a year stay in a Ronald McDonald Kinderhilfe house in Austria, close to their child in hospital.

Each code unlocks one family's story from our Vienna house, shared with their permission.

SOURCE: MCDONALD'S ÖSTERREICH, 2024
#SCANTHESTORY

Ready?

CLUE #1 DROPS IN OUR STORIES.

Turn on notifications 🔔
Tag who you're hunting with 👇
Comment your Bezirk and we'll tell you if a code is near.

#ScanTheStory

REWARDS VIA THE MCDONALD'S APP
#SCANTHESTORY

McDonald's Österreich @McDonalds_AT

You asked: "Does returning my cup actually do anything?"
Yes. 95% of the packaging we collect gets recycled. Scan the QR on your cup to see where it goes next.
Keep the questions coming. #ScanTheStory



10:32 AM · Oct 14, 2026 · **48.2K** Views

214 1.1K 6.8K 48K



mcdonalds now

MCDONALD'S CSR · CLASS CONCEPT

ASK US ANYTHING

about our packaging

Ask us a question

Type something...

answers and full numbers on our site →

Our progress page

Send message

mcdonalds now

Question from a follower (example)

Is your packaging really recycled?

90.93%

of our guest packaging is renewable, recycled or certified. It was 50% in 2018. The goal is 100%.

95% of the packaging collected from customers in our restaurants is recycled.

Not 100% yet. We say it out loud.

more on our site → Our progress page

Sources: McDonald's packaging report (2018, end of 2024; June 2025). Page and QR are proposals.

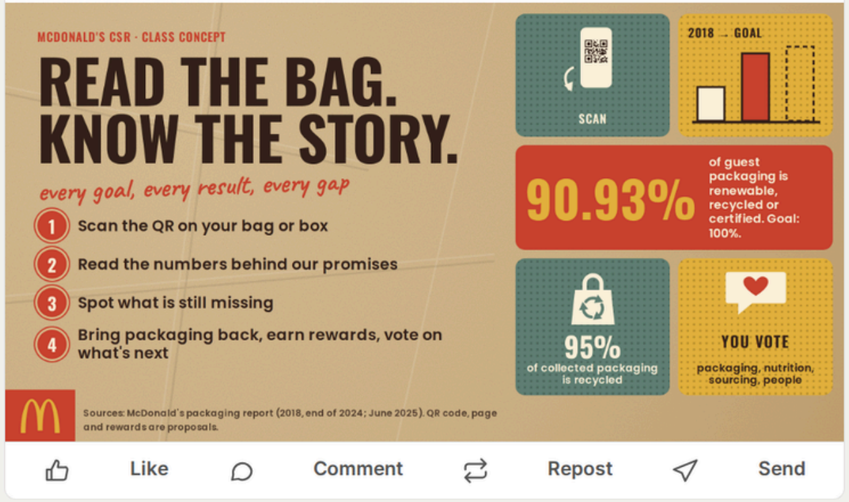
Send message

McDonald's

Progress is easier to trust when you can check it. On selected packaging, a QR code would lead to our goals, our results and the gaps we still have to close.

Guest packaging from renewable, recycled or certified materials: **90.93%** at the end of 2024, up from 50% in 2018. The goal is 100%.

Scan, read and tell us what to fix next. #McDonaldsCSR #Transparency



Like Comment Repost Send

facebook

McDonald's
Just now · 🌐

We have been talking at you for years. Now we would like to listen. Which topic should we fix first: packaging, nutrition, sourcing or employee welfare? Vote and we will share the results in our monthly update. #McDonaldsCSR



Reactions

👍 Like 💬 Comment ↪ Share



9:41 5G

Instagram

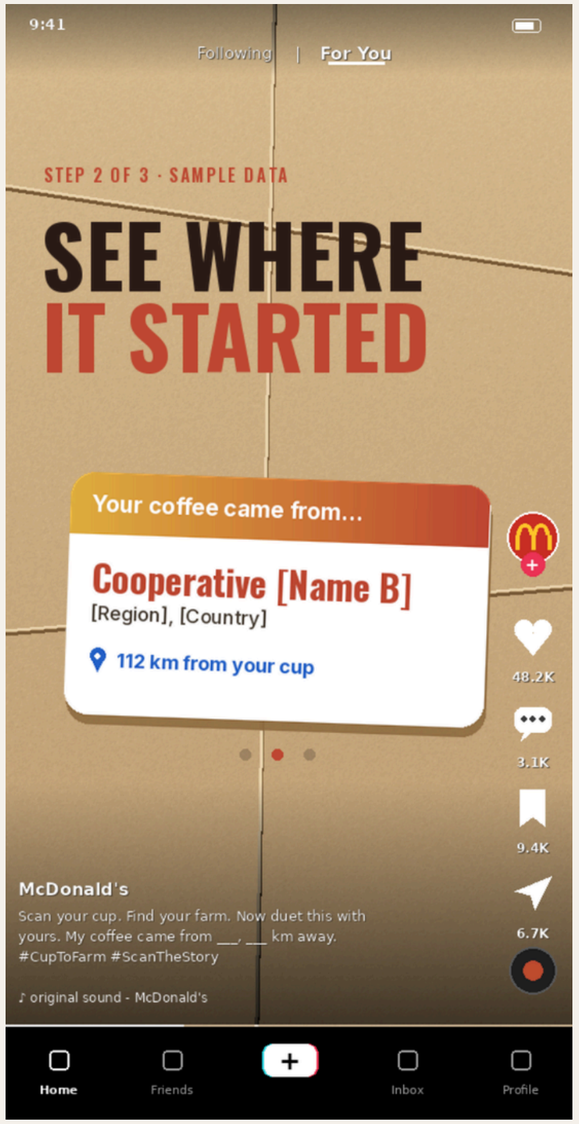
mcdonalds



mcdonalds More than a first job? 27,000 people work in our restaurants in Spain and all promotions inside them are internal. Pay, hours, stress: we do not have every answer. Tell us what to improve. #McDonaldsCSR

Add a comment...


9:41
Following | For You
STEP 1 OF 3
SCAN THE QR
ON YOUR CUP
no app needed. just your camera.
48.2K
3.1K
9.4K
6.7K
McDonald's
Scan your cup. Find your farm. Now duet this with yours. My coffee came from __, __ km away.
#CupToFarm #ScanTheStory
♪ original sound - McDonald's
Home
Friends
Inbox
Profile


9:41
Following | For You
STEP 2 OF 3 · SAMPLE DATA
SEE WHERE
IT STARTED
Your coffee came from...
Cooperative [Name B]
[Region], [Country]
112 km from your cup
48.2K
3.1K
9.4K
6.7K
McDonald's
Scan your cup. Find your farm. Now duet this with yours. My coffee came from __, __ km away.
#CupToFarm #ScanTheStory
♪ original sound - McDonald's
Home
Friends
Inbox
Profile


9:41
Following | For You
STEP 3 OF 3
YOUR TURN
duet this with your reveal
US
Came from...
Finca [A]
48 km away
wait.. mine was only 48 km away?!
YOU
your cup here
48.2K
3.1K
9.4K
6.7K
McDonald's
Scan your cup. Find your farm. Now duet this with yours. My coffee came from __, __ km away.
#CupToFarm #ScanTheStory
♪ original sound - McDonald's
Home
Friends
Inbox
Profile


9:41
Following | For You
JOIN IN · #CupToFarm
COPY THIS
CAPTION
Fill in the blank
My coffee came from
_____,
___ km away.
#CupToFarm #ScanTheStory
duet - stitch - post. we feature the best.
scan to find your farm ->
48.2K
3.1K
9.4K
6.7K
McDonald's
Scan your cup. Find your farm. Now duet this with yours. My coffee came from __, __ km away.
#CupToFarm #ScanTheStory
♪ original sound - McDonald's
Home
Friends
Inbox
Profile

What we expect

- Higher awareness
- Customer engagement
- Increased trust and credibility
- Better local brand image
- Stronger community connections

